We need a *log collector* to fetch log messages from the standard output of all the running applications. Using the Grafana stack, you're free to choose a log collector from among several options. For the Polar Bookshop system, we'll use Fluent Bit, an open source and CNCF-graduated project that "enables you to collect logs and metrics from multiple sources, enrich them with filters, and distribute them to any defined destination" (https://fluentbit.io). Fluent Bit is a subproject of Fluentd, "an open source data collector for unified logging layer" (www.fluentd.org).

Fluent Bit will collect logs from all running containers and forward them to Loki, which will store them and make them searchable. Loki is "a log aggregation system designed to store and query logs from all your applications and infrastructure" (https://grafana.com/oss/loki).

Finally, Grafana will use Loki as a data source and provide log visualization features. Grafana "allows you to query, visualize, alert on and understand" your telemetry, no matter where it is stored (https://grafana.com/oss/grafana). Figure 13.2 illustrates this logging architecture.